Funding stages: what each stage pays for

Barber Republic is a new platform from Johnny and the established Barber Barber business. The MVP is nearing the end of Phase One. The next step is the pre-seed stage. Amounts are from the planning paper of 13 October 2026 (three possible routes), in pounds sterling.

Stage	What it pays for	Evidence needed before the next stage	Planning amounts (route 1 / 2 / 3)
Pre-seed (next)	**Production readiness, tests with the trade, and a paid local pilot**	**Completed paid jobs, returning shops and barbers, measured support cost**	**300,000 / 600,000 / 1,000,000**
Seed	Repeat the service in a second cluster; establish acquisition and support costs	Repeat demand in two clusters; positive margin per completed job	1m / 2m / 3m
Series A	Scale the strongest clusters; add integrations that earn a return	New clusters reproduce retention and margins without founder-led matching	3m / 6m / 10m
Series B	Enter one new geography or segment after local proof	First expansion works after local adaptation and support costs	7.5m / 15m / 25m
Series C (optional)	Wider replication or consolidation	Durable cash generation, clean records, an operating team that runs it	15m / 30m / 50m

Who typically invests at pre-seed: industry operators and marketplace builders as angels, angel syndicates, early-stage funds, and private investors or family offices. A recent Wahoo Services map lists 112 UK B2B investors that did a pre-seed to Series A deal in 2025 and 2026, 28 of them outside London. Fit with Barber Republic is not yet checked.

What the pilot proves, so the next stage can be funded: how quickly requests are filled, the margin on a covered day, how much of the trade rebooks through the platform, and whether the engine works beyond barbering.

Source: Barber Republic "Capital and Exit Pathways", 13 October 2026, and the Wahoo Services UK investor map. The amounts are planning scenarios, not a valuation, offer or agreed terms. They exclude option pools, fees and convertible instruments.